

PENINSULAR INDIA: PALLAVAS, CHALUKYAS & BRAHMANIZATION

PENINSULAR CHRONOLOGY AND POLITICAL → EVIDENCE AND SOURCE CRITICISM → PALLAVA AND CHALUKYA RULER → KANCHI-VATAPI RIVALRY AND REGIONAL → ADMINISTRATION AND LOCAL INSTITUTIONS → LAND GRANTS AND BRAHMANIZATION

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 PENINSULAR CHRONOLOGY AND POLITICAL GEOGRAPHY

PENINSULAR CHRONOLOGY AND POLITICAL GEOGRAPHY

C. 535 CE

INDEPENDENT BADAMI CHALUKYA POWER CONSOLIDATES LATE 6TH C.

SIMHAVISHNU RENEWS PALLAVA EXPANSION EARLY 7TH C.

MAHENDRAVARMAN I AND PULAKESHIN II C. 630S

NARMADA CHECK ON HARSHA C. 642

NARASIMHAVARMAN I CAPTURES VATAPI

8TH C.

535 CE → independent Badami Chalukya power consolidates late 6th c.

→ Simhavishnu renews Pallava expansion early 7th c.

→ Mahendravarman I and Pulakeshin II c.

630s → Narmada check on Harsha c.

642 → Narasimhavarman I captures Vatapi

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- 535 CE → independent Badami Chalukya power consolidates late 6th c.
- Simhavishnu renews Pallava expansion early 7th c.
- Mahendravarman I and Pulakeshin II c.

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- 630s → Narmada check on Harsha c.
- 642 → Narasimhavarman I captures Vatapi
- 8th c. → Vikramaditya II, Rajasimha legacy and mature temple patronage

IMPACT / LIMIT

- 757 → Rashtrakutas end Badami line; Pallavas survive to c. 893.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 757 → Rashtrakutas end Badami line; Pallavas survive to c. 893.

01

STAGE 01 EVIDENCE AND SOURCE CRITICISM MATRIX

EVIDENCE AND SOURCE CRITICISM MATRIX

AIHOLE PRASHASTI

GENEALOGY AND CAMPAIGNS

ROYAL EXAGGERATION

PALLAVA CHARTERS

GRANTS AND LEGITIMATION

FORMULAIC CLAIMS

SANSKRIT + TAMIL EPIGRAPHY

AIHOLE PRASHASTI → genealogy and campaigns

PALLAVA CHARTERS → grants and legitimation

MONUMENTS → patronage, technique and cult

LITERATURE → court, satire and devotion

PORT / SETTLEMENT ARCHAEOLOGY → exchange

royal exaggeration

formulaic claims

attribution limits

genre and redaction

uneven survival

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- AIHOLE PRASHASTI → genealogy and campaigns
- royal exaggeration
- PALLAVA CHARTERS → grants and legitimation
- formulaic claims

METHOD / DEBATE

- SANSKRIT + TAMIL EPIGRAPHY → praise and documentary practice
- MONUMENTS → patronage, technique and cult
- attribution limits
- LITERATURE → court, satire and devotion

HISTORICAL RESULT

- genre and redaction
- PORT / SETTLEMENT ARCHAEOLOGY → exchange
- uneven survival
- RULE: monument first, style label later; inscription data plus ideology.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: monument first, style label later; inscription data plus ideology.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: monument first, style label later; inscription data plus ideology.

02

STAGE 02 PALLAVA AND CHALUKYA RULER LADDERS

PALLAVA AND CHALUKYA RULER LADDERS

PALLAVA CHALUKYA OF BADAMI

SIMHAVISHNU PULAKESHIN I

MAHENDRAVARMAN I KIRTIVARMAN I

NARASIMHAVARMAN I MAMALLA MANGALESHA

PARAMESVARAVARMAN I PULAKESHIN II

NARASIMHAVARMAN II RAJASIMHA VIKRAMADITYA I

NANDIVARMAN LINE FALL TO RASHTRAKUTAS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

PALLAVA CHALUKYA OF BADAMI

Simhavishnu Pulakeshin I

Mahendravarman I Kirtivarman I

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

Narasimhavarman I Mamalla Mangalesha

Paramesvaravarman I Pulakeshin II

Narasimhavarman II Rajasimha Vikramaditya I / II

DEBATE / LEGACY

Nandivarman line fall to Rashtrakutas

ANCHORS: Kanchi-Mamallapuram

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PALLAVA CHALUKYA OF BADAMI
- Simhavishnu Pulakeshin I
- Mahendravarman I Kirtivarman I

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Narasimhavarman I Mamalla Mangalesha
- Paramesvaravarman I Pulakeshin II
- Narasimhavarman II Rajasimha Vikramaditya I / II

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Nandivarman line fall to Rashtrakutas
- ANCHORS: Kanchi-Mamallapuram

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: monument first, style label later; inscription data plus ideology.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: monument first, style label later; inscription data plus ideology.

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MAHENDRAVARMAN I KIRTIVARMAN I

NARASIMHAVARMAN I MAMALLA MANGALESHA

PARAMESVARAVARMAN I PULAKESHIN II

NARASIMHAVARMAN II RAJASIMHA VIKRAMADITYA I

NANDIVARMAN LINE FALL TO RASHTRAKUTAS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

PALLAVA CHALUKYA OF BADAMI

Simhavishnu Pulakeshin I

Mahendravarman I Kirtivarman I

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

Narasimhavarma

Paramesvaravarman I Pulakeshin II

Narasimhavarma

DEBATE / LEGACY

Nandivarman line fall to Rashtrakutas

ANCHORS: Kanchi-Mamallapuram

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

• PALLAVA CHALUKYA OF BADAMI

• Simhavishnu Pulakeshin I

• Mahendravarman I Kirtivarman I

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

• Narasimhavarma

• Paramesvaravarman I Pulakeshin II

• Narasimhavarma

DEBATE / LEGACY

• Nandivarman line fall to Rashtrakutas

• ANCHORS: Kanchi-Mamallapuram

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nandivarman line fall to Rashtrakutas; ANCHORS: Kanchi-Mamallapuram | Vatapi-Aihole-Pattadakal.

03

STAGE 03 KANCHI-VATAPI RIVALRY AND REGIONAL EFFECTS

KANCHI-VATAPI RIVALRY AND REGIONAL EFFECTS

KANCHI <→ VENG

DECCAN ROUTES <→ VATAPI

PULAKESHIN II EXPANDS EAST AND CHECKS HARSHA

MAHENDRAVARMAN-PULAKESHIN CONFLICT

NARASIMHAVARMAN I CAPTURES VATAPI

VATAPIKONDA MEMORY LATER CHALUKYA VICTORIES AT KANCHI

VIRUPAKSHA COMMEMORATION

Pulakeshin II expands east and checks Harsha

Mahendravarman-Pulakeshin conflict

Narasimhavarma

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

• KANCHI <→ VENG / DECCAN ROUTES <→ VATAPI

• Pulakeshin II expands east and checks Harsha

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

• Mahendravarman-Pulakeshin conflict

• Narasimhavarma

DEBATE / LEGACY

• RESULT: rivalry reshaped frontiers, branches, prestige and sacred landscapes.

• KANCHI <→ VENG / DECCAN ROUTES <→ VATAPI

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RESULT: rivalry reshaped frontiers, branches, prestige and sacred landscapes.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: rivalry reshaped frontiers, branches, prestige and sacred landscapes.

04

STAGE 04 ADMINISTRATION AND LOCAL INSTITUTIONS

ADMINISTRATION AND LOCAL INSTITUTIONS

MILITARY ELITE

TERRITORIAL OFFICERS AND REVENUE RIGHTS

GRANTS TO BRAHMANAS AND RELIGIOUS INSTITUTIONS

PEASANT VILLAGE

BRAHMANA ASSEMBLY IN GRANT VILLAGE

MERCHANT-LINKED SETTLEMENT

PROMINENT VILLAGE ELDERS IN CHALUKYA RECORDS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

• KING / COURT / MILITARY ELITE

• territorial officers and revenue rights

• grants to Brahmanas and religious institutions

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

• ur: peasant village

• sabha: Brahmana assembly in grant village

• nagaram: merchant-linked settlement

DEBATE / LEGACY

• mahajana: prominent village elders in Chalukya records

• CAUTION: do not project mature later Chola committee detail backward.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION: do not project mature later Chola committee detail backward.

05

STAGE 05 LAND GRANTS AND BRAHMANIZATION

LAND GRANTS AND BRAHMANIZATION

ROYAL CHARTER

REVENUE RIGHTS + EXEMPTIONS + JURISDICTION

DONEE INSERTION INTO SETTLED OR EXPANDING AGRARIAN ZONES

CULTIVATION + SANSKRITIC LEGITIMACY + CASTE ORDERING

RECIPROCAL RESHAPING OF LOCAL CULTS AND BRAHMANICAL PRACTICE

USEFUL MODEL

INTEGRATION AND HIERARCHY TOGETHER

04

STAGE 04 ADMINISTRATION AND LOCAL INSTITUTIONS

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MILITARY ELITE

TERRITORIAL OFFICERS AND REVENUE RIGHTS

GRANTS TO BRAHMANAS AND RELIGIOUS INSTITUTIONS

PEASANT VILLAGE

BRAHMANA ASSEMBLY IN GRANT VILLAGE

MERCHANT-LINKED SETTLEMENT

PROMINENT VILLAGE ELDERS IN CHALUKYA RECORDS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- KING / COURT / MILITARY ELITE
- territorial officers and revenue rights
- grants to Brahmanas and religious institutions

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- ur: peasant village
- sabha: Brahmana assembly in grant village
- nagaram: merchant-linked settlement

DEBATE / LEGACY

- mahajana: prominent village elders in Chalukya records
- CAUTION: do not project mature later Chola committee detail backward.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION: do not project mature later Chola committee detail backward.

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CULTIVATION + SANSKRITIC LEGITIMACY + CASTE ORDERING

RECIPROCAL RESHAPING OF LOCAL CULTS AND BRAHMANICAL PRACTICE

USEFUL MODEL

INTEGRATION AND HIERARCHY TOGETHER

ROYAL CHARTER → brahmadeya / agrahara

revenue rights + exemptions + jurisdiction

donee insertion into settled or expanding agrarian zones

cultivation + Sanskritic legitimacy + caste ordering

reciprocal reshaping of local cults and Brahmanical practice

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ROYAL CHARTER → brahmadeya / agrahara
- revenue rights + exemptions + jurisdiction
- donee insertion into settled or expanding agrarian zones

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- cultivation + Sanskritic legitimacy + caste ordering
- reciprocal reshaping of local cults and Brahmanical practice
- USEFUL MODEL: integration and hierarchy together

DEBATE / LEGACY

- LIMIT: not every grant created a new village or proved royal weakness.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT: not every grant created a new village or proved royal weakness.

06

STAGE 06 BHAKTI AND RELIGIOUS PLURALITY

BHAKTI AND RELIGIOUS PLURALITY

VAISHNAVA HYMNS, SHRINE ROUTES AND EMOTIONAL DEVOTION

SHAIVA HYMNS, SACRED PLACES AND COMMUNITY MEMORY

RITUAL + LANDED PATRONAGE + POLITICAL VISIBILITY

BUDDHIST GROUPS

CONTINUED DEBATE, INSTITUTIONS AND COURT PRESENCE

INCLUSION STORIES

NANDANAR, TIRUPPAN ALVAR AND ANDAL

ALVARS → Vaishnava hymns, shrine routes and emotional devotion

NAYANARS → Shaiva hymns, sacred places and community memory

TEMPLES → ritual + landed patronage + political visibility

JAIN / BUDDHIST GROUPS → continued debate, institutions and court presence

INCLUSION STORIES → Nandanar, Tiruppan Alvar and Andal

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ALVARS → Vaishnava hymns, shrine routes and emotional devotion
- NAYANARS → Shaiva hymns, sacred places and community memory
- TEMPLES → ritual + landed patronage + political visibility

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- JAIN / BUDDHIST GROUPS → continued debate, institutions and court presence
- INCLUSION STORIES → Nandanar, Tiruppan Alvar and Andal
- LIMIT: devotional access did not abolish caste, patriarchy or elite power

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: vernacular opening within a hierarchical religious field.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT: vernacular opening within a hierarchical religious field.

07

STAGE 07 PALLAVA ARCHITECTURE TRAJECTORY

PALLAVA ARCHITECTURE TRAJECTORY

MAHENDRAVARMAN I

ROCK-CUT CAVES

MANDAGAPATTU, MAMANDUR

NARASIMHAVARMAN I

MAMALLAPURAM RATHAS AND GREAT RELIEFS

SHORE TEMPLE + KAILASANATHA STRUCTURAL PHASE

LATER PALLAVAS

MAHENDRAVARMAN I → rock-cut caves: Mandagapattu, Mamandur

NARASIMHAVARMAN I → Mamallapuram rathas and great reliefs

RAJASIMHA → Shore Temple + Kailasanatha structural phase

LATER PALLAVAS → Vaikuntha Perumal and continuing Kanchi patronage

TECHNIQUE: cave → monolith → structural temple, with overlap

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- MAHENDRAVARMAN I → rock-cut caves: Mandagapattu, Mamandur
- NARASIMHAVARMAN I → Mamallapuram rathas and great reliefs
- RAJASIMHA → Shore Temple + Kailasanatha structural phase

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- LATER PALLAVAS → Vaikuntha Perumal and continuing Kanchi patronage
- TECHNIQUE: cave → monolith → structural temple, with overlap
- MEANING: ritual experiment + royal image + coastal sacred landscape

IMPACT / LIMIT

- RULE: sequence is analytical, not a crude progress ladder.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: sequence is analytical, not a crude progress ladder.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: sequence is analytical, not a crude progress ladder.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT: vernacular opening within a hierarchical religious field.

07

STAGE 07 PALLAVA ARCHITECTURE TRAJECTORY

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ROCK-CUT CAVES

MANDAGAPATTU, MAMANDUR

NARASIMHAVARMAN I

MAMALLAPURAM RATHAS AND GREAT RELIEFS

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LATER PALLAVAS

MAHENDRAVARMAN I → rock-cut caves: Mandagapattu, Mamandur

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IMPACT / LIMIT

- RULE: sequence is analytical, not a crude progress ladder.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: sequence is analytical, not a crude progress ladder.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: sequence is analytical, not a crude progress ladder.

08

STAGE 08 CHALUKYA ARCHITECTURE AND VESARA CAUTION

CHALUKYA ARCHITECTURE AND VESARA CAUTION

VARIED STRUCTURAL EXPERIMENTS AND PLANS

CAVES, CAPITAL LANDSCAPE AND EARLY STRUCTURAL WORK

NORTHERN AND SOUTHERN SUPERSTRUCTURE FORMS SIDE BY SIDE

DRAVIDA FORM, LOKMAHADEVI AND VICTORY MEMORY

COMPARISON POINT FOR MIXED FORMAL VOCABULARY

DURGA TEMPLE

APSIDAL PLAN; NAME DOES NOT PROVE DURGA DEDICATION

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

AIHOLE → varied structural experiments and plans  
BADAMI → caves, capital landscape and early structural work  
PATTADAKAL → northern and southern superstructure forms side by side

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

VIRUPAKSHA → Dravida form, Lokmahadevi and victory memory  
PAPANATHA → comparison point for mixed formal vocabulary  
DURGA TEMPLE → apsidal plan; name does not prove Durga dedication

DEBATE / LEGACY

VESARA: modern shorthand only after site-specific description.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- AIHOLE → varied structural experiments and plans
- BADAMI → caves, capital landscape and early structural work
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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

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- PAPANATHA → comparison point for mixed formal vocabulary
- DURGA TEMPLE → apsidal plan; name does not prove Durga dedication

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VESARA: modern shorthand only after site-specific description.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DURGA TEMPLE → apsidal plan; name does not prove Durga dedication.

09

STAGE 09 ART, LITERATURE AND BILINGUAL COURT CULTURE

ART, LITERATURE AND BILINGUAL COURT CULTURE

SOMASKANDA, SHAIVA-VAISHNAVA PROGRAMMES

BADAMI EVIDENCE WITH SURVIVAL AND ATTRIBUTION LIMITS

PRASHASTI, COURT LITERATURE AND MATTAVILASA-PRAHASANA

DOCUMENTARY EPIGRAPHY AND DEVOTIONAL HYMN WORLDS

LITERARY MEMORY WITH CONTEXT CAUTIONS

MONUMENT + TEXT

KINGSHIP COMMUNICATED THROUGH SEVERAL MEDIA

SCULPTURE / RELIEF → Somaskanda, Shaiva-Vaishnava programmes

PAINTING → Badami evidence with survival and attribution limits

SANSKRIT → prashasti, court literature and Mattavilasa-prahasana

TAMIL → documentary epigraphy and devotional hymn worlds

DANDIN / NANDIKKALAMBAKAM → literary memory with context cautions

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- SCULPTURE / RELIEF → Somaskanda, Shaiva-Vaishnava programmes
- PAINTING → Badami evidence with survival and attribution limits
- SANSKRIT → prashasti, court literature and Mattavilasa-prahasana

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- TAMIL → documentary epigraphy and devotional hymn worlds
- DANDIN / NANDIKKALAMBAKAM → literary memory with context cautions
- MONUMENT + TEXT → kingship communicated through several media

DEBATE / LEGACY

- 2024 GS-I ROUTE: art and literature must appear together.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2024 GS-I ROUTE: art and literature must appear together.

10

STAGE 10 ECONOMY, PORTS AND BAY OF BENGAL LINKS

ECONOMY, PORTS AND BAY OF BENGAL LINKS

AGRARIAN SETTLEMENTS

SURPLUS + TAXES + TEMPLE SUPPORT

CRAFT CENTRES

WEAVING, METAL, SCULPTURE AND BUILDING LABOUR

POLITICAL, RELIGIOUS, LITERARY AND COMMERCIAL CENTRE

COASTAL OUTLET AND PORT-HINTERLAND CONNECTION

MERCHANT GROUPS

AGRARIAN SETTLEMENTS → surplus + taxes + temple support



LITERARY MEMORY WITH CONTEXT CAUTIONS

MONUMENT + TEXT

KINGSHIP COMMUNICATED THROUGH SEVERAL MEDIA

SCULPTURE / RELIEF → Somaskanda, Shaiva-Vaishnava programmes

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SANSKRIT → prashasti, court literature and Mattavilasa-prahasana

TAMIL → documentary epigraphy and devotional hymn worlds

DANDIN / NANDIKKALAMBAKAM → literary memory with context cautions

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2024 GS-I ROUTE: art and literature must appear together.

10

STAGE 10

ECONOMY, PORTS AND BAY OF BENGAL LINKS

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AGRARIAN SETTLEMENTS

SURPLUS + TAXES + TEMPLE SUPPORT

CRAFT CENTRES

WEAVING, METAL, SCULPTURE AND BUILDING LABOUR

POLITICAL, RELIGIOUS, LITERARY AND COMMERCIAL CENTRE

COASTAL OUTLET AND PORT-HINTERLAND CONNECTION

MERCHANT GROUPS

CRAFT CENTRES → weaving, metal, sculpture and building labour

AGRARIAN SETTLEMENTS → surplus + taxes + temple support

KANCHI → political, religious, literary and commercial centre

MAMALLAPURAM → coastal outlet and port-hinterland connection

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT: maritime connectivity is not proof of a Pallava overseas empire.

11

STAGE 11

PENINSULAR REGIONALISATION ANSWER SPINE

PENINSULAR REGIONALISATION ANSWER SPINE

C. 550-900 AS A FORMATIVE EARLY-MEDIEVAL TRANSITION

PALLAVA-CHALUKYA RIVALRY + VENGI CONSEQUENCE

GRANTS + UR/SABHA/NAGARAM + HIERARCHY

BHAKTI + JAIN/BUDDHIST PLURALITY + SOCIAL LIMITS

NAMED PALLAVA AND CHALUKYA SITES BEFORE STYLE LABELS

KANCHI-MAMALLAPURAM AND SELECTIVE MARITIME VITALITY

RIVALRY, LAND, SHRINES AND LANGUAGE ROOTED REGIONAL STATES.

OPEN → c. 550-900 as a formative early-medieval transition

POLITY → Pallava-Chalukya rivalry + Vengi consequence

LOCALITY → grants + ur/sabha/nagaram + hierarchy

RELIGION → bhakti + Jain/Buddhist plurality + social limits

ART → named Pallava and Chalukya sites before style labels

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → rivalry, land, shrines and language rooted regional states.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

PENINSULAR INDIA

PALLAVAS, CHALUKYAS & BRAHMANIZATION — ADVANCED

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

5. UPSC TRAPS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

ADVANCED DEBATE

LEGACY / NUANCE

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.